

EMERGENCY SHEET

Ransomware hit your practice. Do this first.

Breathe. Then work the list: five calls, in order. Print this page and tape it inside your server room door.

- 1 Your IT support**
Systems are locked, screens show a ransom note. Disconnect affected machines from the network — unplug the cable. Do NOT power anything off: dead machines lose forensic evidence.
- 2 Your cyber insurance breach hotline**
The 24/7 number on your policy. They assign a breach coach and approve the vendors. Call before you hire anyone or pay anything.
- 3 A healthcare breach attorney**
Don't have one? Your insurer will assign one. From here, everything goes through counsel — that keeps forensics under privilege.
- 4 The FBI — ic3.gov**
File a report at ic3.gov. It helps law enforcement track the group, and a paper trail of cooperation looks good to regulators later.
- 5 Your partners and administrator**
Short and factual: what happened, what's contained, who's engaged. No speculation, nothing in writing beyond the facts.

DO NOT

- × **Pay the ransom yet.** Payment doesn't guarantee your files back, and paying some groups is illegal.
- × **Keep using the systems.** Every click can spread it further.
- × **Delete anything.** Logs, emails, the ransom note itself — that's evidence.
- × **Post about it.** No social media, no press, until your attorney says so.

After the first hour

Your attorney runs the playbook from here: forensics first, then notifications. Under HIPAA you have 60 days to notify HHS and affected patients — but your counsel decides the timing and the wording, not the clock.

This is a first-response sheet, not legal advice. Your breach attorney makes the legal calls — this just gets you to them faster.